**A**

Drifting peak (same physical $D_s$) | Jumping peak (same rate) | Jumping peak (rate ∝ perimeter)

Time (×10³) — C20 — C60

Heading $C(\ell)$ — Lag (×10³)

$\alpha = 2$ (C = 20, C = 60) | $\alpha = 0$ (curves coincide) | $\alpha = -1$

**B**

C: 20 30 40 50 60

Drift only | Drift + same-rate jumps | Drift + perimeter-rate jumps

Local exponent $\alpha$ — Input fraction $f$

drift | same-rate jumps | perimeter-rate jumps

$f_{1/2}/f_{1/2}(C_{20})$ — Circumference C

Drift | + same-rate jumps | + perimeter-rate jumps

$\propto C$

**C**

Wave-pinning: 20 30 40 50 60 | Holmes: 20 30 40 50 60 | Spring: 1 1.5 2 2.5 3 | Goryachev: 20 30 40 50 60

C; Spring ×20 in fold panel

Wave-pinning | Holmes | Spring | Goryachev

Local exponent $\alpha$ — Input fraction $f$

$f_{1/2}/f_{1/2}(C_{20})$ — Circumference C

Wave-pinning | Holmes | Spring | Goryachev

$\propto C$

**D**

Wave-pinning, $f = 0.03$ | Holmes, $f = 0.02$ | Spring, $f = 0.005$ | Goryachev, $f = 0.01$

Time (×10³) — switch — C20 — C60 (C1 — C3 for Spring)

Heading $C(\ell)$ — Lag (×10³)

$\alpha_{20,60} = 2.1$, 95% CI [1.9, 2.3] (C = 20, C = 60)

$\alpha_{20,60} = 1.4$, 95% CI [1.3, 1.5]

$\alpha_{20,60} = 1.8$, 95% CI [1.7, 1.9]

$\alpha_{20,60}$ unavailable

**E**

Wave-pinning | Holmes | Spring | Goryachev

$D_s/D_s(C_{\min})$

$\lambda_{\text{eff}}$ — Scored events — Mixture fit

$k_{\text{pred}}/k_{\text{obs}}$

Multiple-front fraction

Input fraction $f$

## Figure 4. Null models for size-dependent heading persistence

A. Simulated drifting and relocating peaks on small and large rings. Grayscale kymograph widths follow circumference and time increases upward; each pair shares its declared seed. Ensemble heading autocorrelations below use small-ring solid and large-ring dotted curves. Fixed physical drift, same-rate relocation and perimeter-rate relocation give size exponents 2, 0 and −1, respectively.

B. Simulated mixtures illustrate how relocation erodes a geometric size advantage. Input fraction is f; the illustrative dependences are $D_s = 8.8f^2$ and $\lambda = 135f^4$, with perimeter-rate relocation multiplying λ by C/40. The decay rate is $k(\ell) = -\ln C(\ell)/\ell$; α is minus the local slope of ln k against ln circumference. Noise tolerance $f^{1/2}$ is the first downward crossing of correlation 0.5 at the fixed reference lag. Gray shades encode increasing circumference. Line styles distinguish mixtures in the tolerance-fold panel; its dashed guide is proportional to circumference.

C. Local exponents use model hues and light-to-dark circumference ramps. Markers show designed inputs, open markers identify forced conditions, vertical intervals show pointwise 95% uncertainty, and outward triangles mark off-scale values or tails. The right panel shows tolerance folds with model-specific markers; Spring circumference is multiplied by 20. 125/260 neighborhoods resolve; Goryachev contributes 11. Largest-size tolerance folds are Wave-pinning 2.373, Holmes 2.155, Spring 3.088, Goryachev 4.122.

D. Matched first-replicate model histories use the selected designed inputs, with physical widths and shared grayscale activity scales within each model. Black outside ticks identify persistent dominant-region replacements. The ensemble curves below include end-to-end exponents and 95% intervals where estimable. At every selected input, small-ring reference-lag correlation is below 0.4 and large-ring correlation exceeds 0.6; the enlarged rings retain heading longer.

E. Drift is normalized by its value at the smallest size at the same input (C = 20, or Spring 1); unity is the equal-physical-drift expectation giving α = 2. Rows below show effective jump rate, predicted/observed heading decay and multiple-front fraction. Solid curves and pointwise whole-seed intervals use counted replacement rate times mean angular loss among scorable events; dashed curves use the existing detector-free wrapped-Gaussian/uniform mixture at the shortest cadence. Unscorable events remain in the rate and exposure; their angles are represented by the scorable-event mean, with coverage and missing-angle bounds in the supplement. The jump-rate ordinate includes zero on a symmetric-log scale; open points identify forced conditions, and triangles retain off-scale ratios. Detector-free curves are point estimates. Predicted rates lie within 15% of observed rates in 57 of the 154 estimable conditions. In the multiple-front-majority regime, 0/33 event-based predictions and 3/33 detector-free predictions are within 15%. Agreement at weak input therefore does not establish closure as fronts multiply. Native model clocks remain separate, and multiple-front fractions are descriptive.